



PHARMACOLOGIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Pharmacologists conduct experiments on chemicals that have medicinal properties in order to research their effects on people, animals, and the environment. Working for pharmaceutical companies, universities, hospitals, or government laboratories, they study the beneficial and possible harmful effects of these substances, using their data to develop new drugs and treatments that are safe to use.



SALARY

Newly qualified ★★☆☆☆

Senior pharmacologist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Highly competitive field • Growing sector due to advances in research and increased human life expectancy • Opportunities in pharmaceutical industry, hospitals, and universities

CAREER PATHS

An advanced degree is required to enter this scientific profession; many senior researchers hold a PhD and have experience of conducting related research at college level. Pharmacologists usually specialize in developing drugs in a specific area, such as those that work on the heart, or the nervous or digestive systems.

GRADUATE While having a degree in pharmacology is preferable, other subjects such as biochemistry, biomedical sciences, physiology, and toxicology can provide an entry into this career. Work experience with a pharmaceutical company during your studies is also an advantage.

POSTGRADUATE Many pharmacologists hold both a PhD and a PharmD—a doctor of pharmacy degree.

TOXICOLOGIST Carries out clinical and laboratory studies to identify toxic chemicals and substances for a range of purposes such as new product development in the pharmaceutical or petrochemical industries.



PHARMACOLOGIST As a pharmacologist, you might be involved in non-laboratory work such as sales and marketing or product licensing for new drugs. With experience, you can expect to move into more senior roles with increased managerial responsibilities.